

Objects and OOP

CS 350

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Concepts of Objects

Curly-Obj-Immut

Implementing Objects

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- To add a new variant, we needed to refactor *every single* definition that uses type-case to have a new case for the new variant

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 - Since you have to add the new method

OOP vs Algebraic Datatypes

	Add new variant	Add new operation
Datatypes	Needs global refactoring	Local additions only
Objects	Local additions only	Needs global refactoring

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- Like Tuples in Python

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{object {{SYMBOL <expr>}*} {SYMBOL {SYMBOL} <expr>}* }
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- Name comes from Smalltalk, history of OOP

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 - Inside an object's methods, there is a special variable called `this`
 - Refers to the object that the method is being called on, so we can get e.g. field values from methods

Example

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```
{let1 {mkCircle
      {lam r
       {object {{radius r}}
                ;; All methods take one parameter,
                ;; so we just ignore the parameter
                {getArea {x} {* {get this radius}
                               {* {get this radius} 3.14}}}}}
      {let1 {unitCircle {mkCircle 1}}
            {send unitCircle getArea 0}}}
```

- Produces 3.14

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{let1 {mkSquare
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- Produces 4
- Same interface as circle, can use interchangeably if only call methods

Implementing Objects

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- Tricky bit: making sure there's a value for `this` in scope for method calls
 - Making sure it's the *right* value

New Expression Variants

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(define-type Expr
  ...
  (objectE [fields : (AssocList Symbol Exp)]
           [methods : (AssocList Symbol (Symbol * Exp))])
  (getE [obj-expr : Exp]
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  (sendE [obj-expr : Exp]
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- Nothing fancy, just the literal tree representation of the previous syntax

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 - Send has expression for the object whose method we're calling, the name of the method, and an expression for the argument

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 - No need for separate symbol field, closureV stores symbol

Starting Language

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- Assignment 6 will be integrating Objects and Stores
 - Building a small language like Python or JavaScript

Interpreting Object Creation

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```
(define (interp [env : Env]
                [e : Exp] : Value
  (type-case Exp e
    [(objectE fields methods)
     ;; Each named field expression gets turned into a name-value pair
     (objV (map (lambda ([pr : (Symbol * Exp)])
                  (pair (fst pr) (interp env (snd pr))))
              fields)
           ;; Each method gets turned into a closure
           (map (lambda ([pr : (Symbol * (Symbol * Exp))])
                  (pair (fst pr) (closureV (fst (snd pr))
                                             (snd (snd pr))
                                             env))))
              methods))]))
```

Interpreting Field Lookup

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```
[(getE obj-expr field-name)
 ;; Dynamic type check
 (type-case Value (interp env obj-expr)
  [(objV fields methods)
   (lookup fields field-name)]
  [else (error 'interp "not an object")])])]
```

Interpreting Method Calls

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```
(sendE obj-expr method-name arg-expr)
  (let [(obj-val (interp env obj-expr))
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    ;; dynamic type check
    (type-case Value obj-val
      [(objV fields methods)
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 - The entire object's value bound to 'this

Passing the self reference

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- Like `self` in Python, `this` in Java/C++/JS

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{let1 {cons {lam {h t}
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 - Its tail (empty if empty)
- Can do {get someList length} or {send someList tail 0} on empty or cons, and will work in either case
 - Return of methods carried around with the list

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{object {} {call {x} body}}
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- Can even do recursion

```
;; factorial with objects  
{let1 {fact  
  {object {}  
    {call {x}  
      {if0 x  
        1  
        {* x {send this call {- x 1}}}}}}}}}
```